GUJARATI COLLECTION

NO. 10



KATHIAWAD (SAURASHTRA) ORIGIN

Lasaniya Batata

Fiery Kathiyawadi Garlic Potatoes

Gujarat's Spicier Side

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Lasaniya Bataka

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

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Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Where Gujarati Sweetness Gives Way to Heat

Most of the dishes in this collection reflect the sweet-tangy-spicy balance associated with mainland Gujarati cooking, but travel to Kathiawad — the Saurashtra peninsula in the western part of the state — and the flavor profile shifts noticeably. Kathiyawadi food largely sets aside the sweetness that defines Surti and other mainland Gujarati cooking in favor of bold garlic, generous chili, and a more direct, fiery intensity, reflecting the region's distinct history, drier climate, and pastoral traditions.

Lasaniya bataka — "lasaniya" meaning garlicky in Gujarati — exemplifies this Kathiyawadi character perfectly: potatoes simmered in a deep red gravy built on a generous amount of garlic paste and red chili, entirely unsweetened, a world away from the gentle, sugar-touched shaak found in the rest of this collection. It's the dish that surprises people expecting all Gujarati food to taste mild and sweet.

Kathiyawadi cuisine as a whole has gained increasing recognition within India in recent years, with dedicated Kathiyawadi restaurants popularizing dishes like this one to audiences who may not have realized just how much regional variation exists within a single Indian state — lasaniya bataka standing as one of the most approachable and beloved introductions to that spicier, garlic-forward side of Gujarat.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Where Gujarati Sweetness Gives Way to Heat, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Represents Kathiyawadi cuisine, the distinctly spicier, garlic-forward cooking tradition of Gujarat's Saurashtra peninsula, contrasting with the sweeter mainland Gujarati style found elsewhere in this collection. Reflects the region's drier climate and pastoral traditions, historically shaping a heartier, bolder approach to spicing. Increasingly popularized through dedicated Kathiyawadi restaurants across India in recent years. A useful dish for understanding the genuine diversity within Gujarati cuisine, beyond its more commonly known sweet-savory reputation.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

15m	30m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Wooden spoon

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Lasaniya bataka keeps refrigerated for up to 4 days and, like many garlic-forward curries, tastes even better the next day. It freezes well for up to 2 months.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Baby potatoes, halved (or regular potatoes, cubed)	1½ lbs	700 g	1½ lb
Oil	4 tbsp	60 ml	4 chammach
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Garlic, minced or pasted	3 tbsp	30 g	3 chammach
Whole garlic cloves — optional, for extra punch	8–10	8–10	8–10
Tomato, pureed	2 medium	200 g	2 medium
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Kashmiri red chili powder	2 tsp	6 g	2 chammach
Regular red chili powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Coriander-cumin powder blend	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Water	1½ cups	360 ml	1½ katori
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Kashmiri red chili powder gives good color without excessive heat; if you want an even more authentic Kathiyawadi fire, increase the regular red chili powder to taste. Baby potatoes are traditional and hold their shape beautifully, but regular potatoes cut into similar-sized pieces work just as well. This dish uses only common pantry ingredients otherwise, making it accessible worldwide.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Building the Garlic Base

01 TEMPER THE SPICES

Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop. Add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle.

02 ADD THE GARLIC

Add the minced garlic (and whole cloves if using), cooking for 1–2 minutes until fragrant — take care not to let it brown too much, which can turn bitter.



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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Building the Garlic Base, continued

Chef tip. the generous garlic quantity is entirely intentional and central to this dish's identity — don't be tempted to reduce it.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The garlic should turn fragrant and lightly golden, not deeply browned or crisp, before you move on to the next step.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Cooking the Potatoes

03 ADD TOMATO AND SPICES

Add the tomato puree, turmeric, both chili powders, and the coriander-cumin blend. Cook for 8–10 minutes, until the mixture thickens into a deep red masala and the oil separates slightly at the edges.

04 ADD THE POTATOES

Add the halved baby potatoes, stirring to coat thoroughly in the deep red masala.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Cooking the Potatoes, continued

05 ADD WATER AND SIMMER

Pour in the water and salt, bring to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer, covered, for 15–18 minutes, until the potatoes are completely tender and the gravy has thickened to a medium consistency.

Texture indicator. the gravy should be a deep, glossy red, clinging generously to the potatoes, with the intense garlic aroma clearly present throughout.

06 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Skimping on garlic to make the dish milder defeats its entire purpose — lasaniya bataka is meant to be boldly garlicky and spicy. If you want a gentler dish, this collection has plenty of milder options instead.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served with bajra rotla (millet flatbread) and a wedge of raw onion, the classic rustic Kathiyawadi pairing.
- A staple at Kathiyawadi restaurants and thalis, known for their generally spicier, heartier offerings.

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How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A bold, satisfying side dish alongside simpler breads or rice to balance its intensity.

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a fiery, garlicky potato side alongside grilled proteins for a fusion-style meal.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Heat Right

- A generous, unapologetic hand with garlic is what defines this dish — don't hold back.
- Balancing Kashmiri chili powder (for color) with regular chili powder (for heat) lets you control the dish's fire without sacrificing its deep red appearance.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- This dish genuinely improves with a day of resting in the refrigerator, as the garlic and chili flavors continue to deepen.
- Make a larger batch when you're already cooking, since it reheats beautifully for a second meal.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some Kathiyawadi restaurants finish the dish with a final tempering of extra whole garlic cloves fried until golden, scattered on top just before serving for a dramatic garlic punch.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

220 kcal	4 g	32 g	9 g	4 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Kathiyawadi Lasaniya Bataka	the classic fiery version featured here.
Lasaniya Bataka with Bajra Rotla	served specifically alongside millet flatbread for the complete Kathiyawadi experience.
Mild Lasaniya Bataka	a toned-down version for those wanting the garlic flavor without as much chili heat.

Why is this so different from other Gujarati dishes in the collection?

It represents Kathiyawadi cuisine specifically, a spicier, garlic-forward regional style within Gujarat, distinct from the sweeter mainland Gujarati cooking featured in most of this collection.

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Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I reduce the garlic?

You can, though it significantly changes the dish's character — this recipe is intentionally garlic-forward, in keeping with authentic Kathiyawadi style.

Is this the spiciest dish in the collection?

Generally yes — Kathiyawadi cooking is known for being noticeably spicier than mainstream Gujarati cuisine, and this dish is a good representative example.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Lasaniya	Gujarati for "garlicky," describing this dish's dominant flavor.
Kathiyawadi	referring to the cuisine of Kathiawad (Saurashtra), known for bolder, spicier flavors than mainland Gujarati cooking.
Bataka	Gujarati for potato, the primary ingredient in this dish.
Rotla	a thick millet flatbread, a classic Kathiyawadi pairing for this dish.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Lasaniya Bataka

15m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Easy
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

DISH

Baby potatoes	700 g
Oil	60 ml
Mustard seeds	4 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Garlic	30 g
Whole garlic cloves — optional	8–10
Tomato	200 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Kashmiri red chili powder	6 g
Regular red chili powder	3 g
Coriander-cumin powder blend	3 g
Water	360 ml
Salt	6 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Temper the spices.** Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop.

02 **Add the garlic.** Add the minced garlic (and whole cloves if using), cooking for 1–2 minutes until fragrant — take care not to let it brown too much, which can turn bitter.

03 **Add tomato and spices.** Add the tomato puree, turmeric, both chili powders, and the coriander-cumin blend.

04 **Add the potatoes.** Add the halved baby potatoes, stirring to coat thoroughly in the deep red masala.

05 **Add water and simmer.** Pour in the water and salt, bring to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer, covered, for 15–18 minutes, until the potatoes are completely tender and the gravy has thickened to a medium consistency.

06 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Baby potatoes	700 g	☐ Oil	60 ml
☐ Mustard seeds	4 g	☐ Cumin seeds	4 g
☐ Asafoetida	pinch	☐ Garlic	30 g
☐ Whole garlic cloves — optional	8–10	☐ Tomato	200 g
☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g	☐ Kashmiri red chili powder	6 g
☐ Regular red chili powder	3 g	☐ Coriander-cumin powder blend	3 g
☐ Salt	6 g	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g

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